



Quinn Mistletoe

JOURNALIST

Off the record? Nothing is ever off the record.

FOR QUINN MISTLETOE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

You write for *Toy Trade Weekly*, and you came tonight as a guest, "for the eggnog".

COSTUME

Easy: Trench coat, press badge.

Go all out: a 1940s newshound: belted trench coat, a fedora with a PRESS card in the band, and a notepad.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** you've interviewed him twice
- **Charlie Bell:** sends you press releases
- **Alex Snow:** a regular in your industry gossip column

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Get an exclusive quote from everyone in the room
- Find the real story behind tonight
- Never reveal a source

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You write for *Toy Trade Weekly*. You came as a guest "for the eggnog".

YOUR SECRET

You're undercover, chasing the story of the MegaMart sale.

You are innocent

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Quinn



Your manner: Charming, nosy and always "off the record". Lean in close, write everything down and answer questions with questions.

LINES TO TRY

- "Just a friendly chat. Nothing's on the record. Probably."
- "My source is very good. And very anonymous."
- "Could I get a quote from you about Nick?"

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Smile: "I'm here for the story, not the mug. Journalists don't poison sources."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Ask everyone, casually, whether the company is changing hands.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Gossip: MegaMart has been buying up small toy companies all year.
- Gossip: you've heard Nick and Jamie were a couple once.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan, "off the record", about the company's future.
- Ask Alex what Snow Toys thinks of MegaMart.

MINI TASK

Get an "exclusive quote" from three suspects and write them down for your story.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Reveal what your source told you: the sale contract says **all designs belong to the company**, so the Jingle Bear and every other toy Robin made go to MegaMart. Robin gets nothing.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- The sale was signed today at 4:55. Your source is very good.
- Nobody who designed toys for Frost & Fable will own their work after the sale.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan when the staff were going to be told.
- Ask Morgan whether everyone keeps their job.

MINI TASK

Say your front-page headline aloud to the room.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--------------------------------------|--|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh |
| ☐ Alex Snow | ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell |
| ☐ Frankie Fir | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Admit why you're really here if pressed.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You've been writing everything down all night. Offer your notes to the Inspector.
- If pressed, admit you're here for the MegaMart story.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Taylor who has been paying for gossip tonight.
- Ask Charlie to describe the 9:50 photo for your article.

MINI TASK

Write the first line of your news story in your notes and read it out before ballots.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker

Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece

Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker

Taylor Star · Hired Santa

Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener

Jamie Pudding · Village Baker

Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director

Casey Sleigh · Caterer

Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant

Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager

Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist

Riley Carol · Hired Pianist

Nick Frost · the victim